



Cheap IC created by IBM

IBM has created the first cheap electronic-photonics IC. This chip integrates both electronic and optical components into one. <http://dgit.in/SWFjLS>



NASA crashes Grail probes

NASA deliberately crashed two space probes in order to end a Lunar interior mission. The crash site will be named after Sally Ride.

- OS- Windows 7 Ultimate
- Motherboard: Gigabyte G31M-S2L
- HDD : Seagate Barracudda 500 GB
- Network Adapter: Realtek RTL 8168C (p)/ 8111c (p) Family PCI-E Gigabit ethernet NIC [NDIS 6.20]

Of late I have been facing quite a few problems with my PC. I've been unable to format my HDD. I tried several times but it shows up an error. After fully formatting the HDD I've been unable to install any OS, because the setup interrupts and says: "SETUP UNABLE TO FORMAT THE DRIVE". Please help me out!

Kshitij Saini

A Try changing the SATA data cables and using a different power cable. If it still refuses to format, you probably have a faulty drive.

If you can connect it to another PC with an OS, try formatting on that and make a partition of about 40 GB in the beginning of the drive, leave it in RAW format, and try and install the OS on the partition that follows. If that doesn't work, try a first partition of 100 GB next and repeat. If even that fails, it looks like you need a new drive.

Warning: even if one of these methods works, your drive has started getting corrupted / damaged, and it may not last very long, so ensure you backup everything that you store on this drive.

Pen drive only works with set-top box

Since the digitisation of cable TV was ordered, I bought the Dish TV+ with recorder. I tried recording a program, but it is only played in the set top box through their system. But whenever I connect my pen drive to my PC, it asks to format it. I have tried using different OS as well as with different file-systems but the pen drive is unrecognisable. Could you please tell me in which file-system does the DTH

operators code their transmissions. Is any decoder available?

Akshay Puntambekar

A This is done on purpose by the DTH operator in order to ensure that you cannot pirate the recorded content. As per the terms of agreement, you have agreed to this, and cannot bypass this copyright protection.

We cannot give you the solution as it would amount to encouraging piracy, but I am sure there are some enterprising fellows who have done so and posted solutions online.

Be warned though, you will be doing something illegal that could amount to you losing your DTH connection.

Will my board support PCIe 3.0 cards?

I want to know whether my existing motherboard Gigabyte G41MT-ES2L will support cards such as GTX 650?

The card is said to be running on a PCI 3.0 x16. The term 3.0 adds to my confusion as I am now wondering about whether my motherboard supports that technology. Also will my existing board support the card? Will I need to get a new PSU to run it? My existing CPU is rated at 450W.

When I checked the RAM slots, it mentions DDR3 support and my memory is also DDR3, but on the website it shows that the board supports DDR2. Now that is confusing.

Mainak Dev

A So long as your motherboard supports PCIe x16 slots, you will be able to use the NVIDIA GTX 650. The GTX 650 can support PCIe 3.0 speeds, whereas your motherboard is rated at PCIe 2.0. Naturally PCIe 3.0 is rated to run faster than PCIe 2.0, but since you are using an older chipset with an older processor, the card will run with PCIe 2.0 speeds. The GTX 650 is backward compatible with PCIe 2.0 motherboards as well and will run just fine. The GTX 650 will run with PCIe 2.0 speeds which is around 5 Giga-transfers per second (5 GT/s). In the real-world, you will not see any

noticeable performance drop as such. Your PSU should be enough for the GPU as the max TDP for GTX 650 is around 64 W.

Your motherboard supports only DDR3 RAM according to the official website. You should use DDR3 RAM modules on it.

Desktop gadgets acting strange

I have problem regarding my desktop gadgets, which do not display properly. I bought this laptop about a year ago. The configurations are:

- Dell Inspiron N5110
- Intel Core i3-2330M CPU @ 2.20 GHz
- Windows 7 Home Basic
- 3 GB RAM
- 320 GB Harddisk

Niraj Gandhi

A You can go to this link (<http://goo.gl/aTxEA>) and download the Reset_gadgets.bat file. Save this BAT file on the desktop. Right click on it and 'Run as Administrator'. You will notice the Command Prompt window flashing as the BAT file runs. On completion, restart the system to apply the changes. Check if the gadgets are properly visible now. If not, then just uninstall and reinstall the faulty ones.

Another option to try out, which is just a manual method of the one stated above is as follows:

Go to Start>All Programs>Accessories and then right click on Command Prompt and select Run as Administrator. Type out the following commands and after each command press Enter and click on OK before going to the next one.

```
regsvr32 jscript.dll
regsvr32 atl.dll
Regsvr32 "%ProgramFiles%\Windows Sidebar\sbdrop.dll"
Regsvr32 "%ProgramFiles%\Windows Sidebar\wlsrv.dll"
reg delete "HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Internet Settings\Zones" /f
"%ProgramFiles%\Windows Sidebar\sidebar.exe" 
```



Dish+-Setup-Box-A5